

CHEN ZHANG

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I am a Project Researcher at the Research and Development Center for Large Language Models (LLMC), National Institute of Informatics (NII), Tokyo. I received my Ph.D. from Wangxuan Institute of Computer Technology, Peking University, advised by Prof. Yansong Feng. My research aims to make LLMs more inclusive and intelligent across diverse human languages, including:

(1) **NLP for Low-Resource Languages:** Developing multilingual LLMs with stronger support for low-resource languages and improving accessibility for underrepresented communities.

(2) **Multilinguality in LLMs:** Understanding and improving cross-lingual transfer of knowledge and reasoning abilities in LLMs.

(3) **LLMs for Language Science:** Leveraging LLMs to model linguistic phenomena, such as language contact and acquisition, for deeper insights into how human languages function and evolve.

EXPERIENCE

Project Researcher

2026 - Present

Research and Development Center for Large Language Models (LLMC), National Institute of Informatics

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Student in Natural Language Processing

September 2021 - July 2026

Wangxuan Institute of Computer Technology, Peking University

B.Sc. in Computer Science

September 2017 - June 2021

Department of Computer Science and Technology, Peking University

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Efficient Low-Resource Language Adaptation via Multi-Source Dynamic Logit Fusion

Chen Zhang, Jiuhe Lin, Zhiyuan Liao, Yansong Feng. ACL 2026

An Empirical Study of Many-Shot In-Context Learning for Machine Translation of Low-Resource Languages

*Yinhan Lu, Gaganpreet Jhaji, **Chen Zhang**, Anietie Andy, David Ifeoluwa Adelani. AACL-IJCNLP 2026*

Read it in Two Steps: Translating Low-Resource Languages with Code-Augmented Grammar Books

Chen Zhang, Jiuhe Lin*, Xiao Liu, Zekai Zhang, Yansong Feng. ACL 2025*

Cross-Lingual Transfer of Cultural Knowledge: An Asymmetric Phenomenon

***Chen Zhang**, Zhiyuan Liao, Yansong Feng. ACL 2025*

MiLiC-Eval: Benchmarking Multilingual LLMs for China's Minority Languages

***Chen Zhang**, Mingxu Tao, Zhiyuan Liao, Yansong Feng. ACL 2025 (Findings)*

Eliciting and Improving the Causal Reasoning Abilities of LLMs with Conditional Statements

*Xiao Liu, Da Yin, **Chen Zhang**, Yansong Feng, Dongyan Zhao. Computational Linguistics 2025*

MC²: Towards Transparent and Culturally-Aware NLP for Minority Languages in China

Chen Zhang, Mingxu Tao*, Quzhe Huang*, Jiuhe Lin*, Zhibin Chen, Yansong Feng. ACL 2024*

Teaching Large Language Models an Unseen Language on the Fly

***Chen Zhang**, Xiao Liu, Jiuhe Lin, Yansong Feng. ACL 2024 (Findings)*

Unlocking the Potential of Model Merging for Low-Resource Languages

Mingxu Tao*, **Chen Zhang***, Quzhe Huang*, ..., Yansong Feng. EMNLP 2024 (Findings)

Harder Task Needs More Experts: Dynamic Routing in MoE Models

Quzhe Huang*, Zhenwei An*, Nan Zhuang, Mingxu Tao, **Chen Zhang**, ..., Yansong Feng. ACL 2024

How Many Answers Should I Give? An Empirical Study of Multi-Answer Reading Comprehension

Chen Zhang, Jiuhe Lin, Xiao Liu, Yuxuan Lai, Yansong Feng, Dongyan Zhao. ACL 2023 (Findings)

The Magic of IF: Investigating Causal Reasoning Abilities in Large Language Models of Code

Xiao Liu, Da Yin, **Chen Zhang**, Yansong Feng, Dongyan Zhao. ACL 2023 (Findings)

Cross-Lingual Question Answering over Knowledge Base as Reading Comprehension

Chen Zhang, Yuxuan Lai, Yansong Feng, ..., Dongyan Zhao. EACL 2023 (Findings)

Extract, Integrate, Compete: Towards Verification Style Reading Comprehension

Chen Zhang, Yuxuan Lai, Yansong Feng, Dongyan Zhao. EMNLP 2021 (Findings)

A review of deep learning in question answering over knowledge bases

Chen Zhang, Yuxuan Lai, Yansong Feng, Dongyan Zhao. AI Open 2021

Why Machine Reading Comprehension Models Learn Shortcuts

Yuxuan Lai, **Chen Zhang**, Yansong Feng, Quzhe Huang, Dongyan Zhao. ACL-IJCNLP 2021 (Findings)

PROJECTS

Lawyer Llama - A Chinese Legal LLM

- One of the first Chinese legal LLMs, 900+ stars on Github.
- Continually pretrained on legal texts and finetuned on legal consultation data curated by GPT-4o.
- Boosted reasoning ability with reinforcement learning on multi-choice questions from legal exams.

Open-Source Resources for Low-Resource Languages

- *ZhuangBench* & *ZhuangRules*: testing whether LLMs can learn an unseen language (Zhuang) from dictionaries, parallel sentences and grammar rules; *ZhuangBench* is included in *LongBench* v2.
- *MC²* & *MiLiC-Eval*: corpus and benchmark for Tibetan, Uyghur, Kazakh and Mongolian; the Mongolian-script subset of *MiLiC-Eval* has been added to *FLORES+*.

Training LLMs from Scratch (*intern in a startup*)

- Training a Llama-2-like 7B LLM on carefully curated 1T-token data.
- Achieving comparable performance with contemporary models in 2023 (ChatGLM2-6B, Baichuan2-7B).
- Extended to 128K context length through continual pretraining and Adjusted Base Frequency.

AWARDS & HONORS

- Outstanding Graduate of Peking University, 2021 & 2026
- President Scholarship, Peking University, 2025
- Award for Scientific Research, Peking University, 2024
- Outstanding Graduates of Beijing, 2021
- Founder Scholarship, 2018 & 2019

ACADEMIC SERVICES

Area Chair:	ACL Rolling Review, LREC
Reviewer:	ACL Rolling Review, *ACL, NeurIPS, AAAI, COLING, LREC, NLPCC
Workshop Organizer:	Widening NLP (WiNLP) 2025 & 2026
Session Chair:	ACL 2026
Student Volunteer:	EMNLP 2021, ACL 2024 & 2025

TEACHING

Teaching Assistant

- Foundations of Natural Language Processing, Peking University, Spring 2024, 2025 & 2026
- Empirical Methods for Natural Language Processing, Peking University, Spring 2022
- Data Structures and Algorithms, Peking University, Fall 2020 & Spring 2021

SKILLS

Programming:	C/C++, Python
Frameworks:	PyTorch, Megatron, VeRL
Human Languages:	Chinese (Native), English (Fluent), Japanese (Intermediate)